IELTS Turbo · Week 4 · Wednesday · Listening and Reading

# Animals and biology

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

## Article: Animal behavior and survival (179 words)

Life on Earth is divided into millions of **species**, each adapted to its own conditions. The relationship between **predator** and **prey** drives much of this variety: a **carnivore** must hunt to survive, while a **herbivore** relies on speed, numbers or **camouflage** to escape. Some creatures are **nocturnal**, hunting only at night, and others **hibernate** through the cold months to save energy.

Much behavior is guided by **instinct** rather than learning. Birds **migrate** thousands of kilometers with no map, and a female will protect her **offspring** until they can fend for themselves. Social species live in a **colony**, where roles are shared among thousands of individuals. Every **organism** has a **gene** code that shapes its body and habits, and over generations the process of **evolution** helps a population to **adapt** to a changing habitat.

Every **mammal** feeds its young on milk, while other groups **reproduce** by laying eggs. People have **brought under control** certain animals since early times: dogs and sheep were **domesticated** long ago. The greatest threat today is **extinction**, which is why scientists **keep track of** numbers in the wild.

## Useful phrases from the article

| Phrase | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **brought under control** | tamed |
| **keep track of** | follow closely |

## The 20 new words

| Word | | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **species** | n | a kind of living thing | *Thousands of species live in the rainforest.* |
| **predator** | n | an animal that hunts others | *The lion is a powerful predator.* |
| **prey** | n | an animal that is hunted | *Rabbits are the main prey of foxes.* |
| **migrate** | v | to travel to another region each year | *Birds migrate south in winter.* |
| **hibernate** | v | to sleep through the winter | *Bears hibernate in caves.* |
| **offspring** | n | the young of an animal | *The female protects her offspring.* |
| **evolution** | n | slow change in living things over time | *Evolution explains how species adapt.* |
| **adapt** | v | to change to live in new conditions | *Camels adapt to desert heat.* |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **nocturnal** | adj | active at night | *Owls are nocturnal birds.* |
| **herbivore** | n | an animal that eats plants | *Cows are herbivores.* |
| **carnivore** | n | an animal that eats meat | *The wolf is a carnivore.* |
| **instinct** | n | natural behavior not learned | *Birds build nests by instinct.* |
| **camouflage** | n | colors that help hide an animal | *The frog uses camouflage to avoid danger.* |
| **mammal** | n | an animal that feeds its young milk | *Whales are mammals, not fish.* |
| **reproduce** | v | to produce young | *Fish reproduce in large numbers.* |
| **organism** | n | a living thing | *A single cell is the simplest organism.* |
| **gene** | n | a part of a cell that controls traits | *Eye color depends on genes.* |
| **extinction** | n | the complete disappearance of a species | *Habitat loss leads to extinction.* |
| **colony** | n | a group of animals living together | *An ant colony can have millions of members.* |
| **domesticate** | v | to tame an animal for human use | *Dogs were domesticated thousands of years ago.* |

## Revision: 10 words from last week

| Word | | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| **excavation** | n | digging to find old objects |
| **artifact** | n | an object made by people long ago |
| **ancient** | adj | very old, from long ago |
| **civilization** | n | an advanced society |
| **settlement** | n | a place where people start to live |
| **ruins** | n | the broken remains of buildings |
| **dynasty** | n | a line of rulers from one family |
| **empire** | n | a group of countries ruled by one power |
| **trade route** | n | a path used for buying and selling goods |
| **inscription** | n | writing carved on stone |

## Practice: fill the gaps

extinction · migrate · domesticate · adapt · colony · predator · mammal · hibernate

1. Habitat loss leads to _____.
2. Birds _____ south in winter.

3. Dogs were _____ thousands of years ago.

4. Camels _____ to desert heat.

5. An ant _____ can have millions of members.

6. The lion is a powerful _____.

7. Whales are _____, not fish.

8. Bears _____ in caves.

## More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

**amphibian** (n): an animal that lives on land and in water
**ape** (n): a large tailless primate
**bacteria** (n): tiny single-celled organisms
**beak** (n): the hard mouth of a bird
**breed** (v): to produce young
**burrow** (n): a hole dug by an animal
**cold-blooded** (adj): with a body temperature that changes
**dolphin** (n): a clever sea mammal
**endangered** (adj): at risk of extinction
**feed on** (v): to eat as food
**flock** (n): a group of birds
**food chain** (n): a series of living things that eat each other
**fur** (n): the hair of an animal
**hatch** (v): to come out of an egg
**herd** (n): a group of large animals
**insect** (n): a small creature with six legs
**invertebrate** (n): an animal without a backbone
**life cycle** (n): the stages of life
**lizard** (n): a small reptile
**nest** (n): a home built by a bird
**pack** (n): a group of wolves or dogs
**parasite** (n): a creature that lives on another
**pest** (n): an animal that harms crops
**pollinate** (v): to carry pollen between flowers
**reptile** (n): a cold-blooded animal such as a snake
**scavenger** (n): an animal that eats dead animals
**shell** (n): a hard covering
**swarm** (n): a large group of insects
**vertebrate** (n): an animal with a backbone
**wildlife** (n): wild animals

## Answers

1. extinction (extinction)
2. migrate (migrate)
3. domesticated (domesticate)
4. adapt (adapt)
5. colony (colony)
6. predator (predator)
7. mammals (mammal)
8. hibernate (hibernate)